

MERIDIAN INTELLIGENCE

Executive Intelligence for Business Owners, Boards and Investors

Meridian Intelligence helps business owners, directors, investors and leadership teams make better business decisions through structured executive intelligence. Every engagement is personally led by John Webb O'Rourke, combining more than forty years of commercial experience with Meridian's proprietary Executive Intelligence Framework. Rather than relying on a single viewpoint, Meridian examines complex business challenges across multiple executive disciplines at once, verifies its findings, and produces clear recommendations, practical actions and structured decision support.

The Founder

John Webb O'Rourke — Founder and Executive Intelligence Adviser. Forty years advising and operating businesses through growth, investment, restructuring, insolvency, property and strategic change, across law, finance, commercial deal-making and, latterly, applied AI. Chair of AHL PLC; Independent Non-Executive Director and Chair of the Audit and Risk Committee of United Hardware. Every engagement is personally directed by John.

The Seven Executive Intelligence Domains

Meridian's intelligence is organised into seven executive domains. Each carries deep, named sub-specialisms drawn from John's direct experience, so a single engagement reaches the full breadth of a top-tier advisory practice while remaining personally accountable to one adviser.

1. Commercial & Transaction

Strategy, partnerships, revenue models and pricing, deal evaluation and negotiation, mergers, acquisitions and disposals, go-to-market, and cross-border trade.

2. Legal & Governance

Corporate governance, directors' duties, regulatory compliance and contracts, employment and workforce matters, intellectual property and technology commercialisation, and wider regulatory and ESG obligations.

3. Finance & Restructuring

Financial analysis, funding structures and investment readiness, insolvency, liquidation and distressed business, tax and structuring, banking, debt, credit and personal guarantees, and insurance and risk management.

4. Property & Development

Transactions, planning and asset strategy, commercial and development property, grants, state supports and public affairs, and hospitality and licensed premises.

5. AI Strategy & Governance

Practical AI adoption, governance and organisational readiness, EU AI Act compliance, and responsible, board-level implementation.

6. Business Growth & Transformation

Operational performance, strategic growth and organisational transformation, family business and succession, and education, training and workforce upskilling.

7. Investment & AI Equity

Investment analysis, equity structuring, AI as an asset class and AI-driven valuations. Presented as reasoned professional judgement, grounded on every figure.

The Sector Lens

Every engagement is read not only through the relevant functional domains but through the industries John has actually operated in, so the advice carries lived sector knowledge, not textbook familiarity:

Agribusiness, food, retail and the co-operative sector · Healthcare, primary care and dental · Property, construction and hospitality · Hardware and builders' merchants.

Meridian's domains have been deliberately broadened to reflect the full range of John's forty years of direct experience. The additional specialisms sit within the existing seven domains rather than fragmenting the offering, so a client meets one coherent intelligence framework, complete in its breadth and personally accountable in its delivery.

How Meridian Works

A business challenge comes in. Meridian routes it to every domain it genuinely touches, and those domains work in parallel rather than in sequence. Each produces its analysis under a strict grounding rule: no figure, authority or claim is presented unless it is sourced and confirmed. The findings are then independently verified, cross-checked before they are relied upon, and consolidated into a single Executive Intelligence Brief: the strategic opportunities, the principal risks ranked, the practical recommendations, the immediate priorities and the longer-term considerations. Every brief is reviewed personally by John before it is presented, and carries an honest status: decision-ready, or with the outstanding points named.

How the Domains Work Together

The strength of Meridian is not any single domain but the way they combine on a real decision. Two recent illustrations:

A new business-line feasibility. A group considering launching a specialist buying operation. Five domains worked the question together: Commercial modelled the opportunity and the analogues, Finance built the scenario economics and break-even, Legal mapped the competition-law and structural constraints, AI Strategy designed the technology layer, and Business Growth set the rollout. The findings were independently verified, corrected where needed, and delivered as one decision-ready brief with every professional gate named, inside a single day.

A major property and funding decision. A significant purchase to be funded by a linked sale. Four domains combined: Property tested valuation, condition and planning; Finance modelled the funding, the borrowing capacity and the tax; Legal set out the transaction mechanics and the compliance risks; and Commercial framed the negotiation. An independent higher-tier review then re-checked every load-bearing figure, correcting one material point, before the consolidated brief issued with its three open questions clearly flagged.

In each case the client received, in a day, the breadth a large firm would assemble over weeks and several separate advisers, delivered as one accountable, verified view.

Typical Engagements

Strategic business decisions; acquisitions and disposals; investment opportunities; business restructuring, insolvency and turnaround; board and governance advice; AI strategy and adoption; property, development and funding; commercial partnerships; succession and family-business planning; and executive decision support.

The Meridian Difference

Meridian is not about replacing executive judgement. It is about strengthening it. The breadth of a full advisory house, the rigour of independent verification, and the accountability of a single experienced principal who has lived the disciplines and the industries. The objective is not more information. It is better business decisions.